

RASPBERRY PI SECURITY CHECKLIST

A quick security audit for Pi users who want to sleep well at night

Default Pi User Disabled



- **Why it matters:** In old system versions, the user “pi” was the default for all new installations, making it the perfect target for hackers. It’s no longer the default since 2022, but many systems still use it.
- **Quick check:** Open a terminal. If it shows “pi@raspberrypi” or something similar, you need to create a new user.
- **How to fix:** [How to Create a New User on Raspberry Pi](#)

Strong Password Set



- **Why it matters:** If you're still using "raspberry" as your password, it's like leaving your front door wide open. Hackers have automated scripts that try this password on millions of Pi devices every day.
- **Quick check:** If you use a weak password to log in (or worse: no password), drop everything and fix this right now.
- **How to fix:** [How to Change Password on Raspberry Pi OS](#)

Auto-Login Disabled



- **Why it matters:** Auto-login is convenient, but it allows anyone to get access to your session: files, network and other connected devices.
- **Quick check:** If your session opens directly when you reboot your Raspberry Pi, you need to disable that.
- **How to fix:** Open Raspberry Pi Configuration and disable “Auto login”

Sudo Requires Password



- **Why it matters:** Sudo is a shortcut that gives you admin privileges. It lets you do anything on your system. If it doesn't ask for a password, then anyone with access to your regular user account is basically the system administrator.
- **Quick check:** Type `sudo ls /root` - does it ask for your password?
- **How to fix:** [Read tip 6 in our security tips article.](#)

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System Updated



- **Why it matters:** When developers find security problems, they release fixes. But those fixes don't magically appear on your Pi. If you haven't updated in months, you're probably running software with known vulnerabilities that hackers actively exploit.
- **Quick check:** Run `sudo apt update` & `sudo apt upgrade` to see updates.
- **How to fix:** [How to Easily Install Apps on Raspberry Pi OS](#)

Regular Backups Scheduled



- **Why it matters:** Security isn't about preventing every attack, it's about surviving them. Hardware fails, ransomware happens, and mistakes occur. Without backups, it's a bet that you can't lose.
- **Quick check:** When was the last time you backed up your data?
- **How to fix:** [5 Best Ways to Back Up Your Raspberry Pi](#)

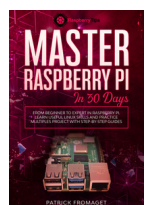
Default SSH Port Changed



- **Why it matters:** Automated bots scan the entire internet looking for port 22 and try to break in 24/7. Switching to a different port keeps you safe from most bots.
- **Quick check:** If you're not specifying a port when you access your Raspberry Pi, it's using port 22 (default).
- **How to fix:** [Read tip 8 in our security tips article.](#)



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Unnecessary Services Removed



- **Why it matters:** Every program running on your Pi is a potential entry point for attackers. Uninstall all services you no longer need and use.
- **Quick check:** Start by running `sudo systemctl list-units --type=service` to see installed services. Do you still need all of them?
- **How to fix:** [How to Uninstall Programs on Raspberry Pi](#)

Firewall Enabled



- **Why it matters:** While not mandatory, a firewall forces you to open only the ports you need so you only keep the essential ones open.
- **Quick check:** Run `sudo ufw status` and make sure it shows "Status: active" with some rules listed.
- **How to fix:** [Configuring a Firewall on Raspberry Pi](#)

Fail2Ban Installed & Active



- **Why it matters:** This is your digital bouncer. If someone tries to guess your password and fails a few times, Fail2ban won't let them try again for hours. It slows down attackers quite a bit.
- **Quick check:** Run `sudo systemctl status fail2ban` and look for "Active: active (running)".
- **How to fix:** [Install Fail2Ban on Your Raspberry Pi](#)

VPN Access Configured



- **Why it matters:** This is like having a private access to your Pi instead of all doors open. Instead of making services accessible directly on the internet (where millions of bots are scanning), you create an encrypted connection just for you.
- **Quick check:** Do you connect to your Pi via a VPN tunnel or directly?
- **How to fix:** [WireGuard Installation on Raspberry Pi](#)

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System Logs Checked Regularly



- **Why it matters:** Your Pi keeps a detailed diary of who's trying to break in and how. Those logs can tell you if someone's actively targeting your system or if you're just dealing with random internet noise.
- **Quick check:** Check if you can find anything fishy in /var/log files or with the *journalctl* command.
- **How to fix:** [How To Use journalctl Linux command](#)

Root SSH Access Disabled



- **Why it matters:** The root account is the ultimate admin, it can delete everything, install anything, break everything. Never allow SSH access to root logins, even if you have a strong password.
- **Quick check:** Try *ssh root@IP*. It should refuse the connection entirely.
- **How to fix:** [Check Tip 7 in your security tips list.](#)

SSH Keys Used



- **Why it matters:** Passwords can eventually be guessed, even strong ones. SSH keys are like having a unique, impossible-to-duplicate physical key instead of a combination lock.
- **Quick check:** When you SSH into your Pi, does it ask for a password, or does it log you in automatically with a key file?
- **How to fix:** [How to Generate & Use SSH Keys on Raspberry Pi](#)



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